

Nicholas Kadunce

OPERATIONS EXECUTIVE · PLANT MANAGER · P&L OWNERSHIP

OPERATIONAL EXCELLENCE

HIGH-PERFORMANCE TEAMS

LEAN SIX SIGMA BLACK BELT

DATA & AI-ENABLED OPERATIONS

• 724-996-3792

• NicholasKadunce@gmail.com

• nicholaskadunce.com

• [linkedin.com/in/nicholaskadunce](https://www.linkedin.com/in/nicholaskadunce)

I build systems that drive results.

Operations executive with a proven arc from process engineer to plant manager in five years—now leading a high-volume manufacturing site with full P&L accountability. Builds high-performing teams and the operating discipline—daily management, real-time data, planned maintenance, quality governance—that makes performance repeatable. Measurable results across four manufacturers: 36.7% plant output growth, 340% production rate increase, 66% rework reduction, and \$1M+ annual revenue added. Deploys automation and AI where they eliminate manual work and sharpen decisions.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Leadership & Team Development

High-Performance Team Building · Change Leadership · Talent Development & Coaching · Supervisor Standard Work · Engagement & Retention · Cross-Functional Leadership

Continuous Improvement

Lean & Six Sigma (Black Belt) · Manufacturing Optimization · Root Cause Analysis · SPC & Pareto Analytics · Visual Management & 5S

Operational Excellence

P&L Accountability · Safety & Quality Systems (ISO 9001) · Risk Management & Mitigation · CMMS & Planned Maintenance · Supplier & Inventory Management

Strategy, Financials & Digital Tools

KPI Development & Daily Management · Financial Forecasting & Modeling · Production Scalability · Data-Driven Decision Making · AI-Enabled Reporting & Automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

JENNMAR

2025 – Present

Plant Manager — Underground Mining & Tunneling Infrastructure Solutions

Reedsville, WV

Scope: Full P&L · ~80-person site team · Accountable for safety, quality, production & financial performance

Lead end-to-end plant operations for a high-volume manufacturing site. Drive strategic improvements that strengthen KPI accountability, digitize operations, and embed a culture of performance and continuous improvement.

- ▶ Increased plant output **36.7%** in year one by redesigning the operating cadence around a Daily Operations Dashboard—hour-by-hour tracking, downtime Pareto analysis, and statistically derived targets.
- ▶ Built a rolling-average Financial Forecaster generating daily operating-income projections—strengthening financial oversight, streamlining consolidation, and enabling faster executive decisions.
- ▶ Installed a cross-functional daily management system—an automated Operations Performance Summary aligning production, maintenance, quality, and safety on prior-day results each morning.
- ▶ Led the shift from reactive to planned maintenance by implementing FIIX CMMS—disciplined work orders, spares control, and a Maintenance Analytics Dashboard tracking labor hours and work-order volume by asset.
- ▶ Established quality governance with automated SPC and Pareto defect analytics plus a tagged, barriered quarantine zone—ensuring full traceability of hold/rework material and earlier trend detection.
- ▶ Developed front-line leaders through structured Supervisor Standard Work and automated incentive-pay administration—raising accountability while saving hours of indirect labor weekly.
- ▶ Digitized the plant floor with real-time machine monitoring across 16 assets (2.8M+ sensor records) and automated daily performance reporting—eliminating manual data entry so leaders act on data rather than assemble it.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

EOS ENERGY ENTERPRISES, INC.

2023 – 2025

Operations Manager — Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) & Module Operations

Turtle Creek, PA

Scope: 11 supervisors · 6 team leads · 240 technicians across two production buildings

Promoted from Quality Engineer to lead manufacturing operations at a battery-storage scale-up—transforming fragmented processes into data-driven, flow-oriented production.

MODULE OPERATIONS

- ▶ Built the company's first production dashboards—OEE metrics, automated gap analysis, and KPI control charts—enabling real-time visibility and strategic decision-making.
- ▶ Converted subassembly from batch to one-piece flow, increasing production 41% and reducing defects 22%; cut equipment downtime 36% in two months through Pareto-driven mitigation plans.
- ▶ Implemented visual management (Kanban boards, Andon lights) and automated performance and attendance tracking—raising workforce accountability and accelerating response to issues.
- ▶ Built and trained a new 40-person third shift from scratch—the plant's highest-performing shift within one month.

BESS OPERATIONS

- ▶ Grew BESS output from 0.5 to 2.2 units/day—a 340% increase—via Yamazumi workload balancing, takt alignment, and team-based workflows; reduced rework 66%.
- ▶ Integrated an Andon system with automated data collection and control charts for real-time monitoring of quality, downtime, and production; standardized workflows with 5S, safety stocks, and shadow boards.

Quality Engineer — Battery Energy Storage Systems & Module Operations

- ▶ Engineered a high-efficiency battery testing routine, reducing cycle times 60% and lifting overall production throughput.
- ▶ Led defect-reduction initiatives achieving a 30% decrease in scrap defects and fewer downstream quality excursions; automated quality documentation and dashboards for rapid decision support.
- ▶ Obtained ISO 9001 Lead Auditor licensure and spearheaded the internal audit program, aligning operations with international standards.

MESSER AMERICAS

2022 – 2023

Regional Production Engineer — ASU Bulk, Tonnage & Specialty Industrial Gases

Northeast Region, USA

- ▶ Led Six Sigma initiatives boosting Krypton/Xenon production 15%, adding over \$1M in annual revenue.
- ▶ Drove 15+ system enhancement projects across regional facilities—cutting annual downtime by 25 days and improving daily output consistency 16%.
- ▶ Streamlined production and delivery through cross-functional collaboration, reducing average lead times by 30 days; managed regional project and expense budgets with disciplined financial oversight.

JOHNSON MATTHEY

2020 – 2022

Production Team Shift Leader II / Process Control Engineer — Clean Air Division

Smithfield, PA

- ▶ Led a high-performing team of six production technicians and a process control engineer—increasing OEE more than 5% with zero lost-time or recordable injuries across all shifts.
- ▶ Reduced cycle time 8% and defects 4% through targeted optimization of an automated diesel-catalyst line; designed a risk management tool cutting downtime 8 minutes per work order.
- ▶ Mentored technicians and embedded lean problem-solving in daily routines—building the data-driven, continuous-improvement culture that anchored the team's performance.

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

◆ **Certified Lean Six Sigma Black Belt (CSSBB)**
Six Sigma Global Institute (SSGI)

◆ **Certified Lean Six Sigma Green Belt (CSSGB)**
Messer Americas, EMBRACE Training Academy

◆ **ISO 9001 Lead Auditor**
Exemplar Global

◆ **Certified ScrumMaster® (CSM)**
Scrum Alliance

B.S., Chemical Engineering
West Virginia University — Morgantown, WV
Class of 2020